Portfolio self-check

Before you send your portfolio with a job application · for graduates, students and early-career architects

Run through these questions before you send your portfolio with an application. Tick **Yes** when it's done, or **Not yet** when it needs work. A 'Not yet' is simply the next thing to fix.

1. The first minute

1	Does your **opening spread** show your strongest project?	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet
2	Are your **name, email and phone number** clear on the first page?	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet
3	Would a reviewer know **within a minute** what kind of work you do and what you're good at?	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

2. Project selection and order

4	Have you chosen your **best projects** rather than all of them?	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet
5	Are they in a **deliberate order**, opening and closing with strong work?	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet
6	Does the selection show the **range** the role needs, for example design, technical drawings and models?	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

3. Your role

7	Is **your role** clear on every project, and on group or office work, is it clear which parts were yours?	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

4. Narrative

8	Does each project state the **question or brief** it responds to?	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet
9	Can you see each project's **idea** in one sentence and one image?	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet
10	Does each project show how the idea **developed**, not only the final images?	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

5. Layout and hierarchy

11	Does every spread have **one clear lead image**, with short, readable text?	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet
12	Are fonts, grids, captions and drawing styles **consistent** from page to page?	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

6. Length

13	Is the **application version** short enough to look through in a few minutes, with a longer version kept for the **interview**?	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

7. Tailored to the practice

14	Have you adjusted the selection and order to **this practice's work**, and checked the format and length it asks for?	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

8. The file

15	Is it a **single PDF**, under about **10 MB**, unless the practice asks for something else?	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet
16	Is the **file name** sensible, for example firstname-lastname-portfolio.pdf, and does every page open and display correctly?	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

Want a second pair of eyes? In the **Portfolio Review Sprint**, a Principal of blng studio goes through your portfolio with you on a 30-minute video call and tells you what to change first. £70 incl. VAT.
sprint.blng.studio/sprints/portfolio-review-sprint/